

Barabari Collective -2 (Mentoring) Q&A Session

Q1. How are students mapped to business needs / projects?

It is a semi-automated process using two tools that serve as leading indicators for each student — one for communication and one for practical application. The team manually looks into the dashboard numbers (rubric scores) for each student and maps them manually. Tools referenced include Code Guru, Samvad Saathi, and communication about domain.

Q2. How do you define courses and take assessments periodically? How is a score assigned?

There are three assessment patterns / three evaluator assessments for Code Guru. Course work consists of weekly assignments, monthly assignments, and a capstone assignment, plus mock interviews of 5 questions on Samvad Saathi. Scores are based on average and individual results.

Q3. Are mentors taking the mock interviews? How does the mock interview work?

Students register with their role, upload a resume, and choose the domain and difficulty. There is no human in the loop for the interview — there are around five interview questions. Humans are involved only in the mapping and scoring, not in the interview itself.

Q4. Is there any specific job portal / how is job type assigned?

Job type is assigned manually. There is a pre-assessment done by them, and a course is then chosen for the students.

Q5. What is the main purpose of the website — student doubt solving or job finding?

It is communication-oriented and about finding direction around project-specific questions. Examples include when a client needs a feature (communication-oriented) and documentation-oriented needs.

Q6. Who are the users of the platform?

Students are mainly the primary users. The system should be easily vetted / fine-tuned by facilitators.

Q7. Will the mentor and student/client have daily communication?

There are two possible scenarios depending on candidate readiness. If the student is good enough, they directly contact and interact with the client (direct mapping). If the student is not good enough, the mentor comes in.

Q8. How do you judge whether a student is ready for industry, and what metrics are used?

Readiness is based on two parameters: knowledge and speech. For communication, the Samvad Saathi report is the input, covering knowledge (all domains covered) and speech competency (how they speak). For Code Guru, this covers whether the portfolio and mandatory projects are done, attendance, and daily activity. Knowledge refers to domain questions and their answers,

whether the portfolio is good enough, whether they are top users, and class attendance; speech refers to pronunciation.

Q9. What are Samvad Saathi and Code Guru, and what is the input for them?

They are two systems that serve as the context for the final project, which will be used by the admin or students. They provide input to learn about the learner (used by the students only), with the goal of removing the mentor so the chatbot can answer the questions. The student completed a full-stack course with Barabari.

Q10. Do we also have client information as an input, apart from student data?

Only very minimal client information, such as what project and what budget. There is no historic data; the client fills a form like a WhatsApp interface.

Q11. Do we have a feedback system, and why remove the mentor from the system?

There is a feedback window at 2 months, 6 months, and 1 year. The client also gives feedback on the student. The mentor is being removed because when 1,000 students engage, too many mentors would be needed for so many students, and there are not enough skilled mentors.

Q12. Do we need to reduce the manual intervention / automate mentorship?

Yes. The gist is to zoom into the mentorship requirement — not just doubt solving, but client output. What needs to be built is to get client and student details from Samvad Saathi and Code Guru, and to remove mentorship and automate it.

Q13. Will the doubts on the chatbot be technical or communicational?

Both — refer to the slide for the domains of questions; the approach is to identify the domain and expand to the question. The categories of questions and their domains can be categorized. (Note: a chatbot is not recommended.)

Q14. What is the ratio of student to mentor?

Approximately 100 mentors to 600 students. This works out to roughly one mentor answering 33 queries. Projects run about 5 to 8 months.

Q15. How much time do mentors currently spend, and are there human mentors right now?

Every project is of the nature of 5 to 6 months, and mentors are spending almost 5 weeks on these queries. There are currently human mentors, and this system is intended to remove the mentors.

Q16. What happens if a student asks a mentor and no mentor is available?

Currently students wait, and the Barabari / NGO tech team takes it up to answer the student, as they have tech folks.

Q17. How are edge cases handled — a student really good in tech but bad in communication?

There is a threshold number above which they pass; below it they do not pass and are not eligible for the client interface. These are parameterized benchmarks.

Q18. Do students have access to what they built?

Yes, students have access to whatever they build.

Q19. What is the core challenge?

The challenge is to make the platform seamless for digital mentorship. Students come to the platform for digital mentorship after the decision is made.

Q20. If our system does not work, is there a fallback (human mentor) who is given context?

This can be flexible — they are open to multiple solutions. They are open to these features (a human mentor feedback fallback).

Q21. Are all students comfortable with English, or is regional language needed?

The system is for people who have a foundation in English (people comfortable with English). The students have gone through schooling and computers, so they have foundational English knowledge; they cannot say for certain if regional language plays a role, but they are comfortable with English.

Q22. What do you want from the solution?

There are around 1,000 graduates eligible for freelancing and 1,000 projects ready; interfacing is needed for mapping, for smooth mentoring, to cater to the demand using the supply. These graduates are mapped to those projects, and this mentorship ecosystem helps the students.

Q23. Is mapping to the client project in scope?

It is supposed to be done, but it is not in the scope of the challenge.

Q24. Are these students unemployed, and do they only want freelancing?

Yes, the students are not employed and are looking into freelancing; the majority are women who want to go back to the village but want to continue working, with this being their only source of employment. Some of them use freelancing as their income, and some don't have options to get a job. They don't have a choice — they can only do remote work.

Q25. What happens if a doubt is not resolved on the platform?

Good question — think about it; it should be addressed in the solution.

Q26. How will we get application/project details to guide the students, and if the mentor is removed, who provides guidance?

The NGO / Barabari team will provide the information. If the mentor is removed, Barabari will provide the guidance for the project from the client.

Closing note (from the non-profit representative):

Assume that the learner has already been mapped to the client. The focus is on how this mentorship platform caters to all kinds of questions.